"India is the fastest growing market for MySQL in the APAC region"

From a modest launch in 2000, to becoming one of the most widely adopted relational database management systems in the world, and then charting a new path after being acquired by Oracle, MySQL has come a long way. ***Tomas Ulin, VP – MySQL Engineering, Oracle,*** covers a lot of ground in an interview with ***Rahul Chopra, editorial director, EFY Group.*** Amongst other things, he talks of MySQL's continued engagement with the open source community, its continuous evolution to serve new demands and its growing popularity under Oracle's stewardship.

Q How has MySQL evolved in the last few years?

The fact that MySQL continues to be the world's most trusted and widely used open source database gives you an indication of how successful we've been. MySQL's proven track record when it comes to performance, reliability and ease of use has made it the most preferred database for Web based applications. A large number of databases offered on the cloud are based on MySQL technologies. Further, MySQL is available on all clouds, offering great flexibility to businesses and developers.

MySQL powers the world's top social media companies, such as Facebook, Twitter, Tencent, LinkedIn and YouTube. Leading global e-commerce companies, including Uber, Netflix, Airbnb, Alibaba, Booking.com and India based Flipkart use MySQL. Some of the world's renowned fintech firms, like WorldRemit, Square, TransferWise, OnDeck and FutureAdvisor rely on MySQL to manage their business smoothly.

Q With Big Data and the cloud, many new database players seem to be vying for the attention of the community and customers. What's *your* take on this?

MySQL was designed and optimised for Web applications. We continue to innovate and make it contextually relevant for developers and businesses. With cloud adoption rising dramatically, companies are looking to their developers to drive digital transformation initiatives and deliver new modern applications, quickly, and at scale. MySQL offers the much needed agility to developers and businesses, while significantly reducing the cost involved in the process. MySQL is a key component of numerous Big Data platforms, and provides extremely valuable insights using the Hadoop platform.